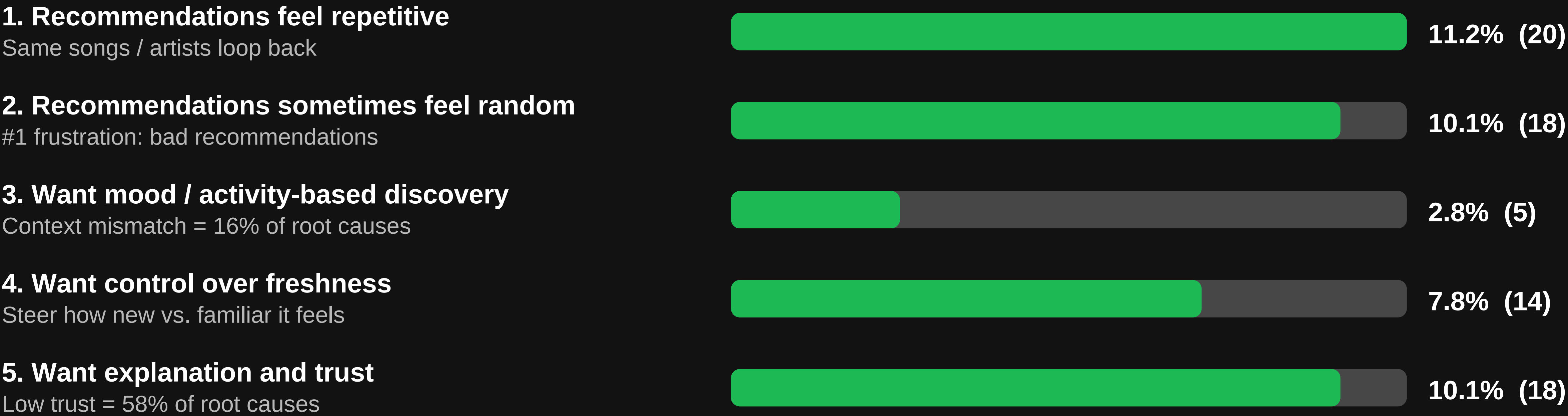


Users want freshness — without losing familiarity

Analysis of 186 real Spotify reviews (App Store 50 · Play Store 136)



Act first — opportunity score (Frequency × Severity × Impact)

P0 Bad recommendations (108) · P1 Same songs repeated (36) · P2 Wrong mood / context (30) · P3 Same artists repeated (16)

What the reviews answer — by the numbers

Q1

Why do users struggle to discover new music?

Low trust drives 58% of root causes; 'bad recommendations' is the #1 frustration (10.1%). Discovery feels risky, not impossible.

Q2

Most common frustrations with recommendations?

Bad recommendations 10.1% · Wrong mood 2.8% · Same songs 2.2% · Same artists 2.2% (P0 opportunity score 108).

Q3

What listening behaviors are users trying to achieve?

Similar-but-fresh 5.6% · Mood-based 2.8% · Deep discovery 2.2% — situational discovery, not just 'new music'.

Q4

What causes repeat listening of the same content?

Low trust 58% + recommendation fatigue 13% + taste bubble 13% of root causes — familiar feels safer than a risky new pick.

Q5

Which segments face different discovery challenges?

Playlist loyalists (12) → fatigue · Passive (6) → risky · Mood (5) → wrong mood · Habitual (4) → repetition · Genre explorers (4) → shallow.

Q6

What unmet needs emerge consistently?

Less-repetitive playlists 6.7% · Fresh-but-familiar 5.6% · Mood-aware discovery 2.8% · Better control 2.2%.

Build next: Anti-repeat / evolving playlists · Fresh-but-familiar discovery mode · Mood-based AI discovery

Final insight — users want discovery that is low-risk, mood-aware, and fresh without becoming random.